came to be reflected in the celebrated work *Transnational Relations and World Politics* edited by Robert Keohane and Joseph Nye[¶]. In another of their major works, *Power and Interdependence*: *World Politics in Transition* (1977), they proposed the complex interdependence as a new account of IR to run alongside realism. Keohane and Nye elucidate the key characteristics of complex interdependence juxtaposing them against the basic assumption of the realist approach to international relations. They identify three main characteristics of complex interdependence:

1. *Societies connected by multiple channels of communication*: The inter-state, trans-governmental and transnational communications, which the realist framework tends to overlook.
2. *An absence of hierarchy among issues*: The agenda of inter-state relations consists of multiple issues that may not be arranged hierarchically. This means that the realist assumption that military security tops the agenda is not acceptable.
3. *Lesser importance of military force*: Against the realist assumption that military force is dominant, Keohane and Nye contend that military force is expensive and in some cases may be irrelevant to a wide range of issues.[20]

From this complex interdependence, there emerges a political process which is quite distinct from the conventional one where there is no fixed goals and distinction of power. Under the traditional analysis of international system, one is expected to anticipate similar processes on a variety of issues. Under the conventional system, militarily and economically strong states tend to dominate a variety of organizations and a variety of issues, by linking their own policies on some issues to other states' policies on other issues. This will result in the stronger states prevailing on even weak issues by using their dominance and ultimately bringing about congruence between the overall structure of military and economic powers and the pattern of outcome on any one issue. World politics, thus, becomes a seamless web. Under the complex interdependence model, however, lack of congruence between various issues increases the difficulties of states to construct linkage strategies. As military force is devalued, militarily strong states find it difficult to dominate